

3B

- ✓ Bill and Melinda Gates speak on stage about their Goalkeepers campaign—a multiyear project dedicated to tracking and accelerating progress towards the UN Sustainable Development Goals

BEFORE YOU READ

- DISCUSSION** A. Read the first paragraph of the reading passage. Then look at the Sustainable Development Goals infographic on page 66. Answer the questions with a partner.
1. Which of these goals do you think are most important?
 2. Which goals do you think will be the easiest to achieve by 2030? Which will be the hardest to achieve?
- PREDICTING** B. Which goals do you think the Goalkeeper's report will show we're making the most progress on? Discuss with a partner. Then read and check your answers.

GOALKEEPERS FOR THE PLANET

- A In 2015 at the United Nations, world leaders adopted 17 Sustainable Development Goals aimed at reducing poverty, inequality, and other global problems by 2030. Such objectives have long been championed by philanthropists¹ Bill and Melinda Gates. In 2017, the Gates Foundation launched Goalkeepers, an **initiative** to spur action² and track progress toward the UN goals. Its 2018 status report says there have been “mind-blowing improvements in the human condition.” The report also calls for more **investment** and **innovation** to ensure this progress continues.
- B Susan Goldberg, editor-in-chief of *National Geographic Magazine*, met with Bill and Melinda Gates for a joint interview on the report, which was released to the public on September 18, 2018.
- C **I’ve just read the Goalkeepers report. Why did you decide to start doing this?**
Melinda Gates: Because we think that the news isn’t really out there—the news that the world has made this incredible progress, this increase in lives saved, the reduction in poverty. The UN set these amazing goals for the future to help us continue to reduce poverty, and we want to make sure that we hold people **accountable** for that progress and really inspire the next generation of leaders who are going to take these tasks on.
- D **What are you seeing in different countries? Who’s doing a great job?**
Bill Gates: Even a very poor country can do a good job on health, can do a good job on agriculture, on education, and that provides a lot of hope because you can copy what’s being done there. Rwanda has been a big **outlier** in the quality of health services. Ethiopia, on agriculture, is growing over 5 percent a year. In education, Vietnam is one we talk about because they’re so far ahead of where you’d expect given their wealth. But it’s when you get those three things together—health, education, agriculture—that eventually these countries can become self-sufficient.
- E **MG:** One of the things that’s also encouraging: Rwanda is a very small country [in population], Ethiopia is the second largest on the continent of Africa—but they have learned the lessons of what has helped people make progress from around the world. So they’re looking at what happened in Asia in agriculture, how did Brazil decrease the stunting³ rate [among malnourished children] so phenomenally across a very large country with lots of poverty.

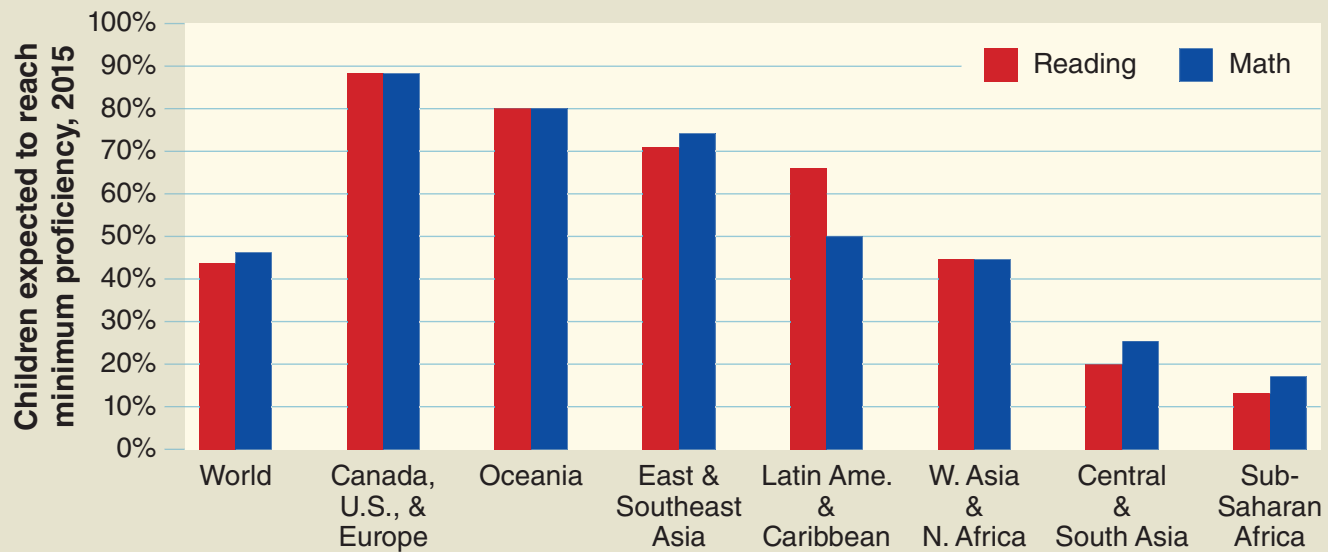
¹ A **philanthropist** is someone who freely gives money and help to people in need.

² If something **spurs** you into **action**, it causes you to do something.

³ The word **stunting** refers to the impaired growth and development that children experience from poor nutrition and poor health.

ACADEMIC ACHIEVEMENT

While more children are attending school in every region of the world, there is still work to be done in many countries to improve the quality of education.



Sources: Bill & Melinda Gates Foundation

- F **When you think about learning from one another, I was struck by the example from Vietnam, where you've got 15-year-olds who are doing as well on international tests in school as people from the United Kingdom or from the United States. What are the lessons from Vietnam that can translate across other countries?**

BG: It's a really new thing to try and get into the amount of learning. The agenda for poor countries up until now has largely been to get the kids into school—and attendance rates have gone up a lot, for girls and boys. The biggest missing piece still is how much knowledge they're gaining. A few countries, by training the teachers the right way and bringing the right material into the classroom, have really achieved learning way beyond what you might expect.

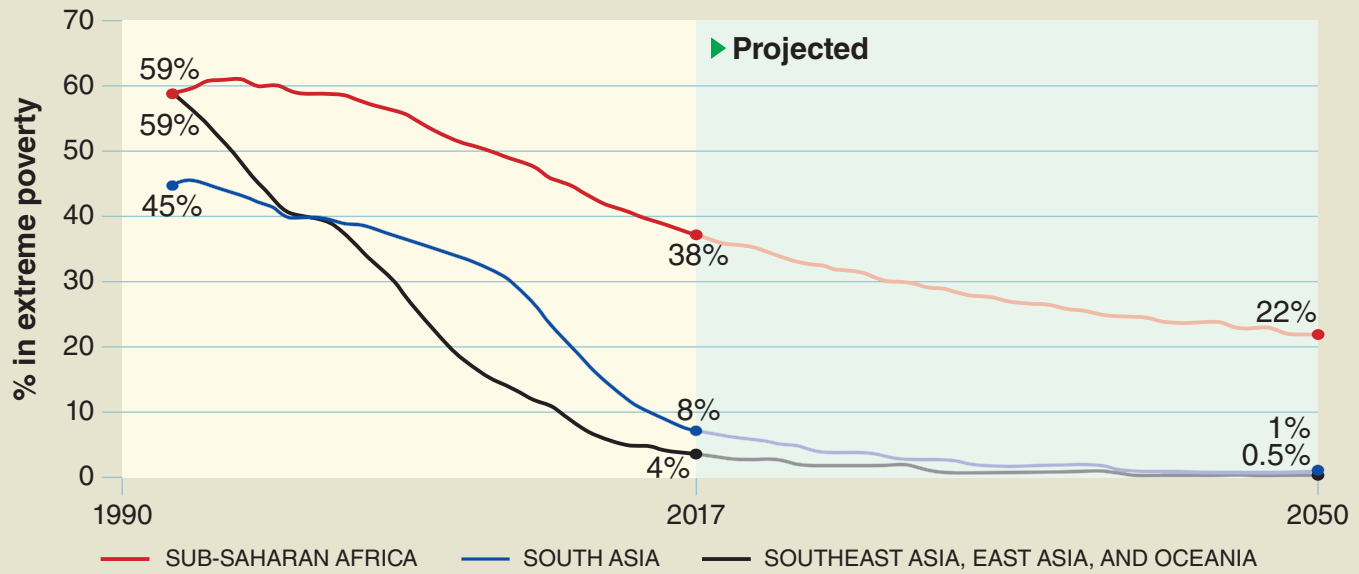
- G **MG:** When you look back at the UN goals that were **initially** set in 2000, one of the goals was to get kids into school, and that has essentially been achieved, particularly at the primary level and quite a bit at the secondary level. So it's neat to see a goal achieved, but now with this next set of goals, it's about how to get the depth of learning and the education right.

- H **Thinking about Africa: How young it is, how many young people there are, is both a huge challenge and a great opportunity. Can you talk a little bit about that?**

BG: The African continent today is about a billion people out of the seven billion on Earth, and as this century goes forward, over half the young people in the entire world will be there. With those people moving into the job market, if the right investments are made—stability, education, health—Africa will have growth and innovation, far more than lots of other places. If, on the other hand, we don't take care of the HIV crisis, then you'll just have more people who will get

POVERTY

Around the world, the percentage of people living in extreme poverty has fallen significantly since 1990. However, in sub-Saharan Africa, the figure remains relatively high, especially in the fastest-growing countries.



infected. If you don't have the right conditions, then the young people, particularly the men, can add to that **instability**. So Africa definitely hangs in the balance.⁴

┌ **Melinda, family planning has been one of the issues that you're most involved in. Can you talk to me a little about that?**

MG: Family planning is crucial anywhere, in any community around the world, because if a woman can decide if and when to have a child, she's going to be healthier and her child is going to be healthier. That's one of the longest-standing pieces of global health research we have ... [If parents] can space the births of those children, they can then feed them, they can educate them, the woman can work and contribute her income to the family. It changes everything in the family **dynamic**, and it changes the community, and ultimately you get these country-level effects where it's good for everybody.

┌ **You've gone all over the world and seen the problems up close. If you could wave a magic wand⁵ and fix just one thing, what would it be?**

BG: The development of children. Today more than half the kids in Africa never fully develop physically or mentally because of malnutrition, their diet, and the diseases they face. With research on the human gut microbiome,⁶ we're gaining an understanding of stunting, why they don't grow. I'm super excited that by the end of the decade we expect to have cheap **interventions** so those kids will fully develop. That means all the investments you make in their education, wanting to benefit from their **productivity**, will work far better. So if there was just one thing, it's the intervention to stop malnutrition.

⁴ If something **hangs in the balance**, no one is sure what will happen to it in the future.

⁵ A **magic wand** is a long thin rod that magicians or fairies wave when they perform tricks, sometimes to make a wish come true.

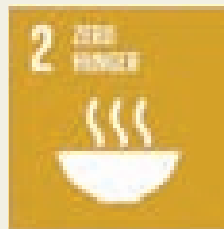
⁶ The **human gut microbiome** refers to the beneficial microbes that live in the human digestive system.



SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT GOALS



End poverty in all its forms everywhere



End hunger, promote improved nutrition and sustainable agriculture



Ensure healthy lives and promote well-being for all at all ages



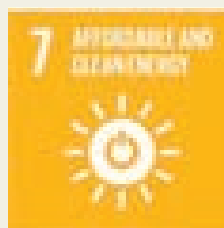
Ensure inclusive and quality education and promote lifelong learning



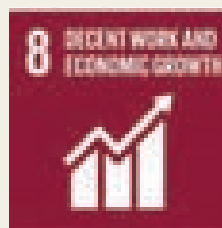
Achieve gender equality and empower all women and girls



Ensure availability and sustainable management of water and sanitation for all



Ensure access to affordable, reliable, sustainable, and modern energy for all



Promote inclusive and sustainable economic growth, and decent work for all



Build resilient infrastructure, and foster innovation



Reduce inequality within and among countries



Make cities and human settlements inclusive, safe, and sustainable



Ensure sustainable consumption and production patterns



Take urgent action to combat climate change and its impacts



Conserve and sustainably use the oceans, seas, and marine resources



Sustainably manage forests, combat desertification, and halt biodiversity loss



Promote peaceful and inclusive societies for sustainable development, and access to justice for all



Revitalize the global partnership for sustainable development

The UN Sustainable Development Goals provide a blueprint for achieving a better and more sustainable future for all by 2030. They aim to tackle global challenges, including poverty, inequality, and environmental degradation

READING COMPREHENSION

A. Choose the best answer for each question.

- GIST** 1. The Goalkeepers report was _____.
a. mostly optimistic
b. somewhat pessimistic
c. extremely pessimistic
d. mostly inconclusive
- REFERENCE** 2. In the third sentence of paragraph D, what does *that* refer to?
a. the fact that new generations of leaders are being inspired
b. the fact that even very poor countries are making progress
c. the fact that many countries are becoming totally self-sufficient
d. the fact that the UN set extremely difficult goals
- DETAIL** 3. Bill Gates indicates that there has been a significant improvement in all three areas of health, agriculture, and education in _____.
a. Rwanda
b. Ethiopia
c. Vietnam
d. none of these three countries
- UNDERSTANDING INFOGRAPHICS** 4. What does the Poverty infographic tell us about Sub-Saharan Africa?
a. Poverty is steadily rising.
b. Poverty is falling more slowly than in other regions.
c. Poverty has remained about the same as in the past.
d. Poverty is at about the same level as Southeast Asia.
- VOCABULARY** 5. The word *phenomenally* in paragraph E is closest in meaning to _____.
a. gradually
b. effortlessly
c. amazingly
d. deliberately
- DETAIL** 6. According to Bill Gates, countries wanting to improve their educational system should focus on _____.
a. getting more and more students into the classroom
b. expanding the size of schools and building more schools
c. training teachers and getting better classroom materials
d. preparing students to take international tests
- SYNTHESIZING** 7. Which of the goals from the list of sustainable development goals is Bill Gates most concerned with?
a. Goal 2
b. Goal 5
c. Goal 7
d. Goal 9

SCANNING B. Look back at the reading passage and charts. Circle **T** (true), **F** (false), or **NG** (not given).

- | | | | |
|--|----------|----------|-----------|
| 1. The Goalkeepers report was produced by the UN. | T | F | NG |
| 2. The stunting rate among malnourished kids in Africa has decreased since 2000. | T | F | NG |
| 3. Nearly half of the world's young people currently live in Africa. | T | F | NG |
| 4. East Asia and Southeast Asia have better reading and math proficiency than the world average. | T | F | NG |
| 5. Poverty in South Asia has increased since 2017. | T | F | NG |
| 6. Math proficiency in Central and South Asia is above the world average. | T | F | NG |
| 7. The UN's Sustainable Development Goals are listed in order of importance. | T | F | NG |

CRITICAL THINKING Evaluating Ideas

Work in a group. Look again at the Sustainable Development Goals. Which three do you think are the most important for furthering development in your country? What are some steps that people could take to help meet each goal? Note your ideas below.

Goal 1: _____

Goal 2: _____

Goal 3: _____



^ A nutrition clinic for mothers in south-eastern Rwanda

Making Inferences (1)

When reading a text, it is often possible to infer information that is not stated directly. We can draw upon information and arguments in the text, together with our own background knowledge, to infer things that are *probably* true. When you make inferences, think about what evidence or information led you to make the inference.

MAKING INFERENCES

A. Look back at Reading B. Choose the best answer for each question.

1. In paragraph A, what can we infer about the UN Sustainable Development Goals?
 - a. Member countries agreed to them.
 - b. The Gates Foundation wrote them.
 - c. They are not officially approved yet.
 - d. They only apply to developing countries.
2. In paragraph C, we can infer that Bill and Melinda Gates produced the Goalkeepers report because _____.
 - a. not enough progress was being made
 - b. a lot of people aren't aware of the UN's progress
 - c. the news media is not good at producing reports
 - d. the UN didn't want to do it
3. Based on information in paragraph E, which of these opinions do you think Melinda Gates would likely agree with?
 - a. It's easier to make progress towards the sustainable goals if a country is large.
 - b. Most African countries should copy Brazil's model for reducing stunting.
 - c. Rwanda and Ethiopia are the best places to live in Africa.
 - d. Countries should consider adopting successful ideas from around the world.
4. According to the information in paragraph I, which of the following statements would Melinda Gates most likely agree with?
 - a. The importance of family planning has only recently been fully understood.
 - b. There is no evidence that family planning has any effect upon a family's overall health.
 - c. It has been known for a long time that family planning is extremely important.
 - d. It's important that governments restrict the number of children families can have.

B. For each item in Activity A, underline the evidence or information in the reading passage that helped you infer the correct answer. Share your ideas with a partner.